

# GR6: Medium-Fi Prototyping

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# The Team



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# Problem / Solution Overview

College students and Gen Z shoppers often turn to online shopping as an emotional activity, but current platforms feel impersonal and overwhelming. This app introduces an AI shopping companion that holds a natural, supportive conversation with the user to understand their mood, context, and intent. Based on that interaction, the AI curates and presents products in a way that feels personal, low-pressure, and emotionally aligned.





# TEXTURIE

Shopping that knows how you feel





# Tasks



# Tasks

- 1     **Simple**     **The user can express their mood or vibe.** *(Doesn't involve direct action by the user, just responding to our prompts, so simple.)*
- 2     **Moderate**     **The user can find new items that feel emotionally aligned and interesting.** *(Involves scrolling, visual analysis, so moderate.)*
- 3     **Complex**     **The user can select pairs of products they are considering and get feedback from the app about which feels “right” for them.** *(Involves more steps, such as selecting the two or possibly more products to compare, and not everyone is likely to go out of their way to use this feature, so complex.)*

# Changes to the Complex Task

We have made slight changes to the wording of the complex task from GR4.  
Before, it was:

**The user can compare products and make the purchase that feels “right.”**

Now, it is:

**The user can select pairs of products they are considering and get feedback from the app about which feels “right” for them.**

This makes it more obvious that this task isn't about the comparisons the user makes in their mind, but rather requesting the AI to make comparisons between the items they have selected. Fewer users are likely to go out of their way to do this.



# Lessons from GR5





# Usability Goals / Requirements

## Less Thinking Involved

- Average time spent on each frame
  - If a frame is confusing it might take for the user to process.
- Facial expressions the user experiences
  - If a user is feeling frustrated, he might make faces or exhibit negative emotions.

### Impact:

If our app doesn't strain the users mind like regular shopping, the user is more tempted to come back and use it again. We want the user to be alleviated of the stress of manually inspecting and comparing each item he finds while online shopping.

## User Friendly UI

- The amount of mistakes the user makes in a frame.
  - If a user makes a mistake, he is probably unaware of the frames UI, and we need to redesign it on our part.

### Impact:

If our app is swift and easy to use, the user is more tempted to come back and use it again. We want the user to be alleviated of the stress of manually inspecting and comparing each item he finds while online shopping.

# Progress Towards Usability Goals

## Less Thinking Involved

### Measurement:

Avg. time per frame: In GR5 testing, users averaged 12.6 seconds per frame, with the Product Comparison screen being the single most time-costly frame for 2 out of 3 users. This indicates the comparison flow was cognitively demanding.

### How the sketched revisions address this:

The added progress bar (Task 1) directly reduces cognitive load by telling users how far along they are, removing uncertainty. The similarity score on product cards (Task 2) lets users process relevance at a glance without reading through full AI explanations.

**What still needs work:** The comparison screen is still the bottleneck. Surfacing pros/cons as a short bulleted list (as User 3 suggested) rather than a paragraph could further reduce time-on-frame.

## User Friendly UI

### Measurement:

Mistakes per frame: Users averaged 1 mistake per session, with both User 1 and User 3 getting stuck specifically on the comparison screen because the icons (buy, compare) were ambiguous.

### How the sketched revisions address this:

Replacing icon-only buttons with labeled buttons (Task 3 change) directly targets the confusion that caused those mistakes. The back button on every screen also reduces the cost of mistakes when they do happen.

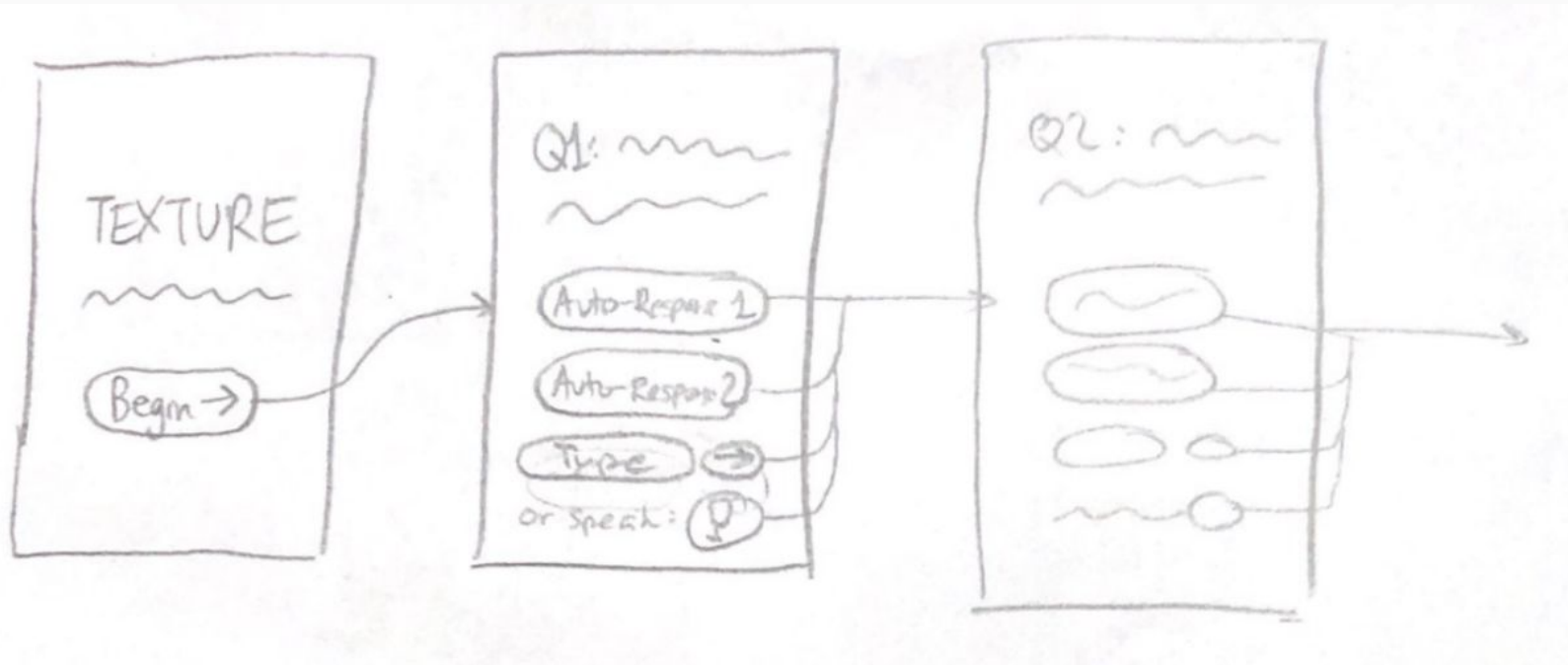
**What still needs work:** The back button currently goes back to the home screen in the low-fi version, which is too aggressive since users lose context. The revised design should ensure back navigates one screen at a time, not all the way home.



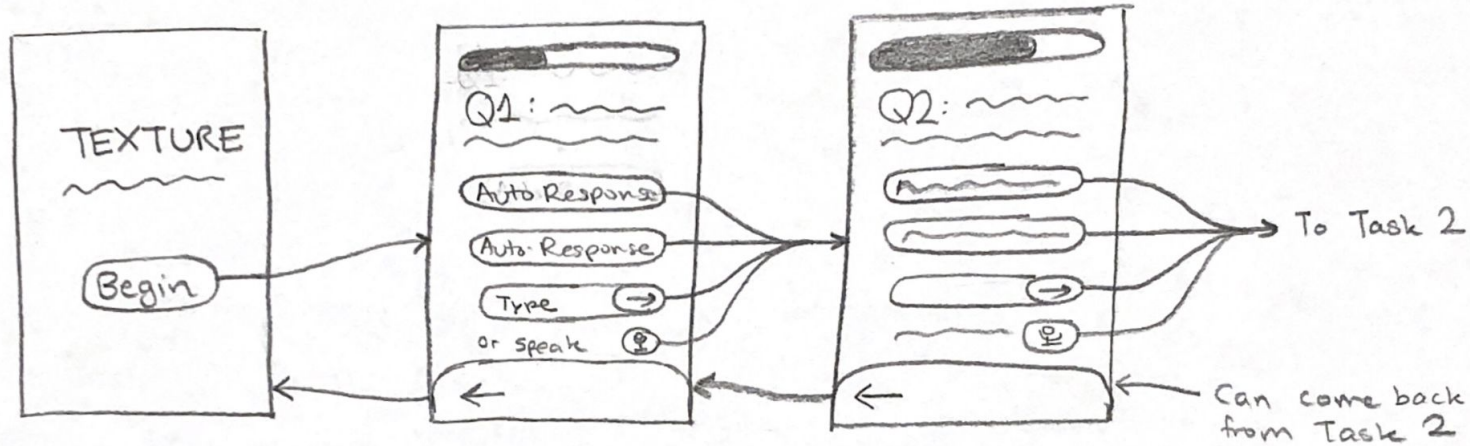
# Revised Interface Sketches



# Task Flow 1: Old Sketch



# Task Flow 1: New Sketch



# Task Flow 1: What We Changed

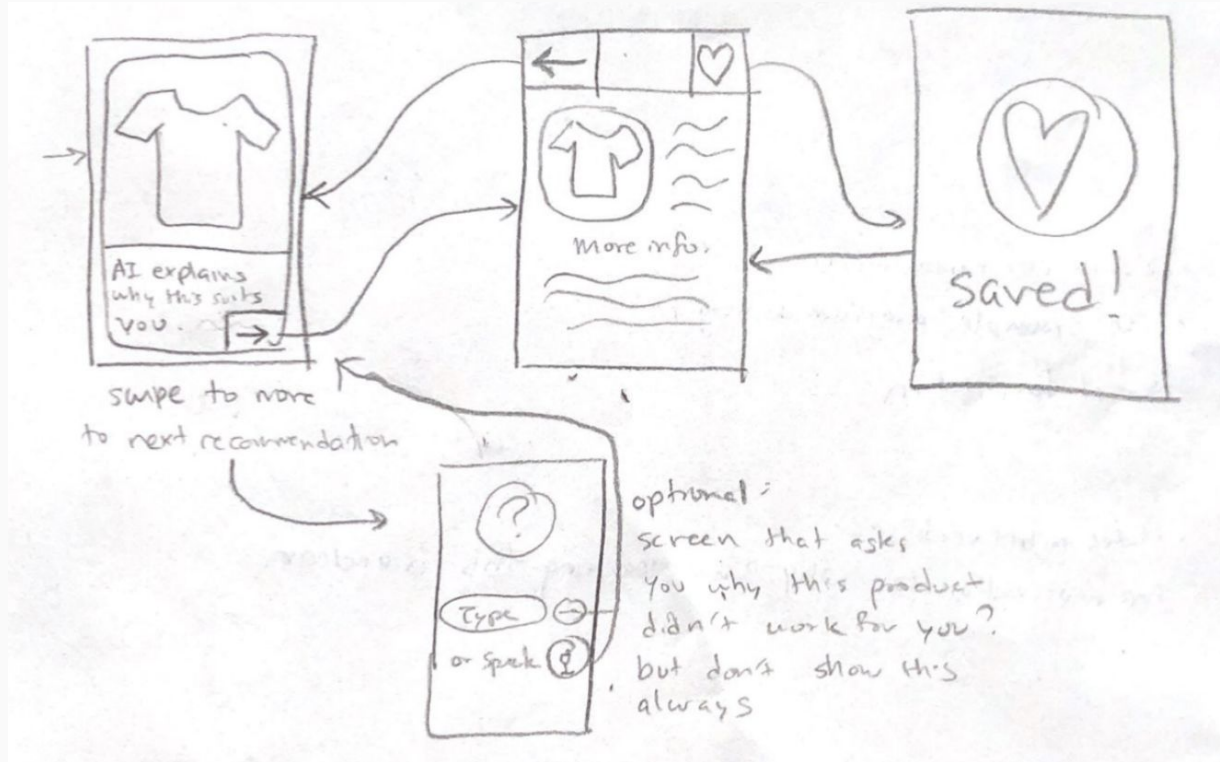
From our Low-Fi user testing, one of the conclusions we came to is that our app should have a way to go back to a previous state in case the app or AI gets stuck in an “echo chamber” that does not correlate with the user’s desire at that moment.

For this reason, we added a back button at the bottom of each screen in case users made the wrong choice. Users will also be able to return to task 1 from task 2 in case they want to fix their answers and see different results.

We also added a progress bar on the top so users can know how much of the Q&A portion they have left to go. This makes users feel less lost when using our app, since they know that these questions are building up to something.

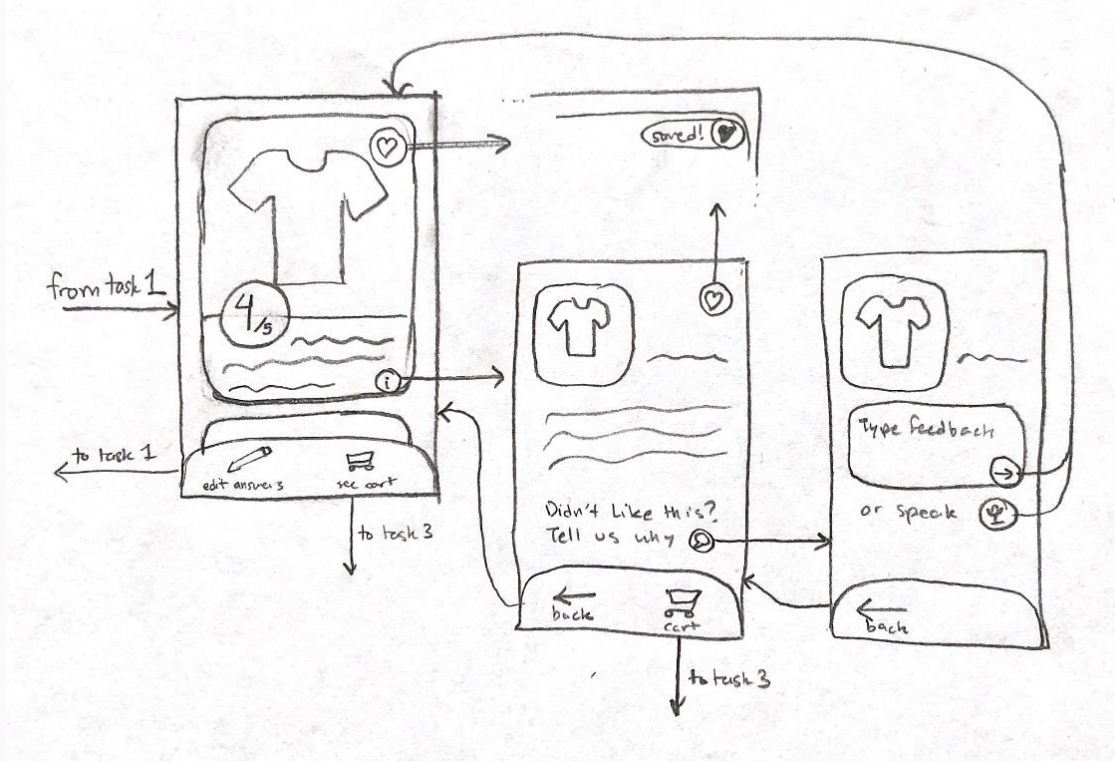


## Task Flow 2: Old Sketch





## Task Flow 2: New Sketch





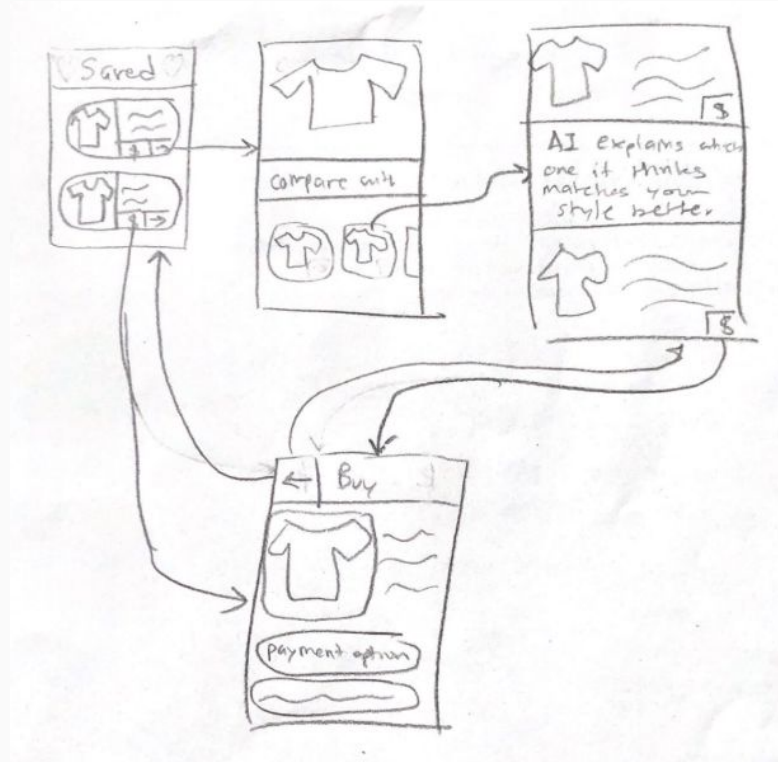
# Task Flow 2: What We Changed

As we did in Task Flow 1, we added a navigation bar with a back button. This lets users go back if they made a mistake of clicked on the wrong button. This also lets users change their responses to the initial questionnaire; our low-fi prototype testers mentioned that they were worried about the AI getting stuck in an echo chamber; being able to change the initial responses gives the users more control over their experience.

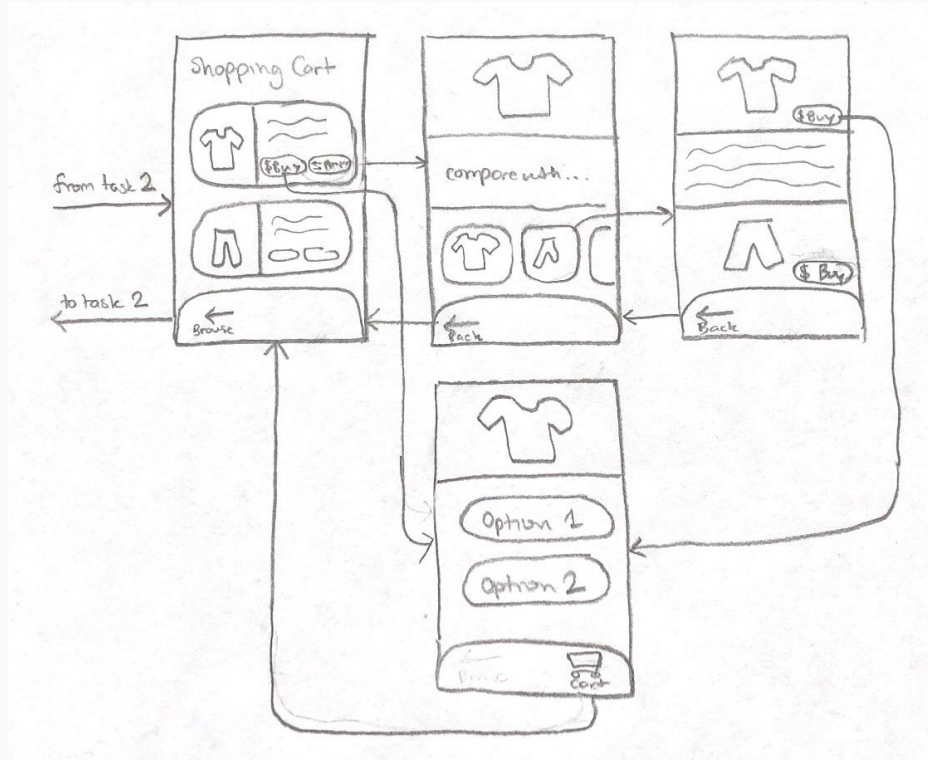
Our users also suggest we provide a “similarity score” for how best the product aligns with the user’s vibe. This helps users quickly identify quantitatively how well the product fits them.



# Task Flow 3: Old Sketch



# Task Flow 3: New Sketch



# Task Flow 3: What We Changed

As mentioned in previous slides, we added the navigation bar at the bottom to allow users to have more control over where to go, especially if they made a mistake in a previous step.

One of the values we chose to improve was clarity. Looking at our old prototype, we noticed that many of the buttons (buy, compare) were only represented by ambiguous icons. We figured that it would be better for users if we also labeled these buttons instead of just using an icon.

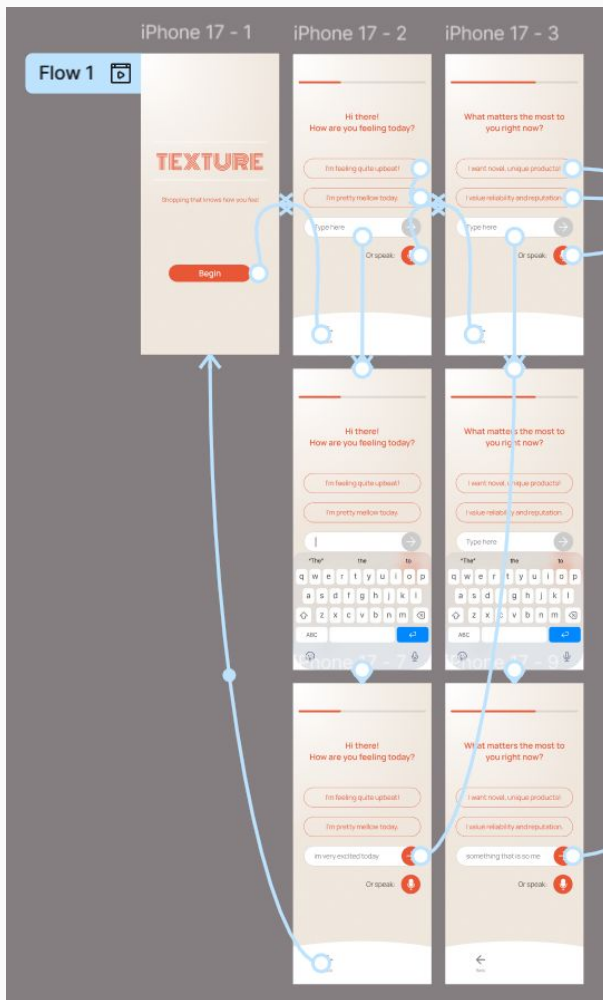




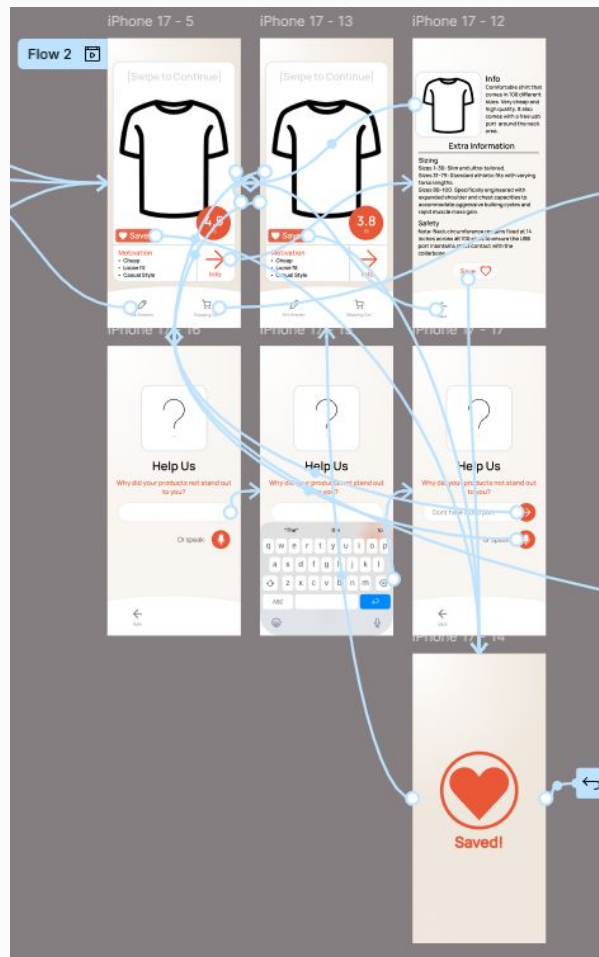
# Medium-Fi Task Flows



# Task Flow 1

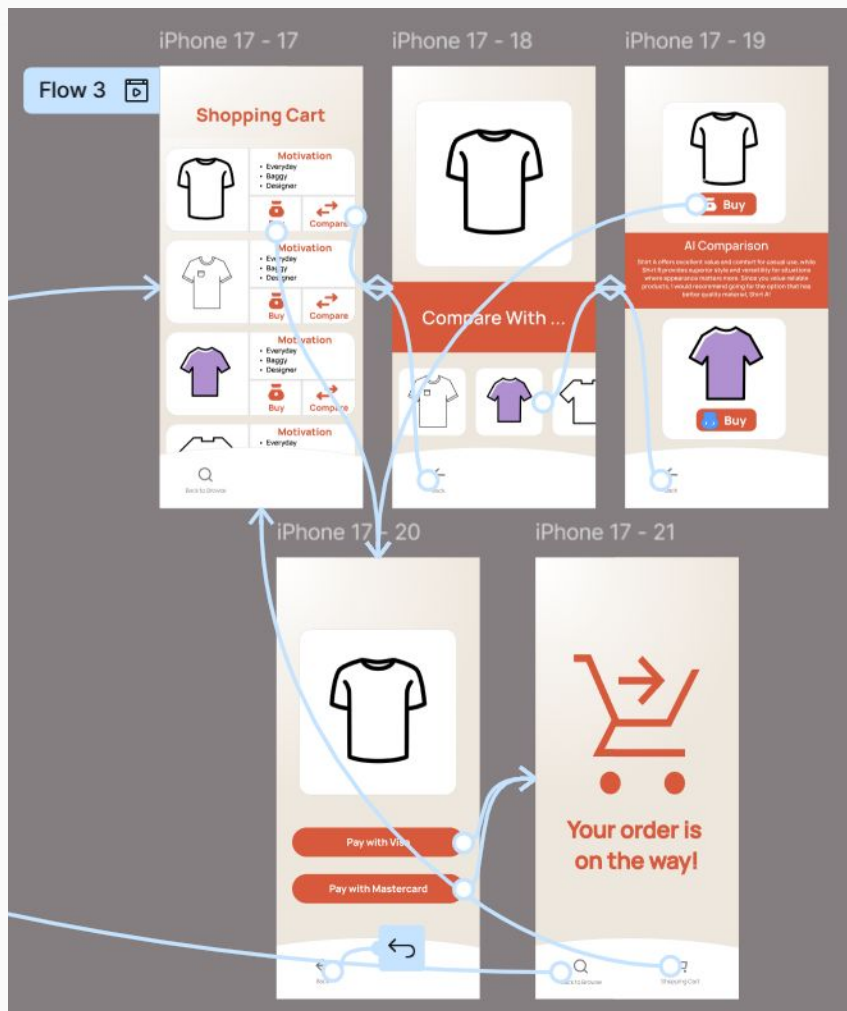


# Task Flow 2





# Task Flow 3





# Prototype Implementation



# Pros of Using Figma

- Figma is great for designing for both visual aesthetics and functionality, whereas paper prototyping only realistically tests functionality, not visual aesthetics as much.
- Figma lets us use transitions to make it seem like the app is actually functional. This makes the user experience a better emulation of the real experience of using an app, and let's us measure time and speed statistics more accurately.
- Figma makes it easier to quickly iterate on designs. If we notice confusion or inefficiencies during testing, we can adjust components, flows, or screen order immediately without having to recreate entire prototypes from scratch.
- Figma allows us to test layout hierarchy, spacing, typography, and color in a way that paper prototypes cannot. This helps us evaluate whether the interface is visually intuitive, not just logically structured.
- Figma also has in-built features that let us see if our color scheme is viewable for individuals with color blindness. This helps us ensure that our app is accessible to a wider audience.



# Cons of Using Figma

- Figma does not have a native voice input feature. This is unfortunate for us, since for Task 1, we wanted the user to have the option to use voice input to make it feel more conversational. However, it's still fine, since we can design a button that looks like a voice input and hardcode the output.
- Similarly, it is too complicated to implement a complete typing interface, so instead, we chose to follow the examples given in section and show a keyboard. The user taps the keyboard, and a predetermined response auto populates. This means that the app feels too controlling, but is ultimately the only feasible option to get our prototype out quickly.
- Figma does cannot store memory of what specific products the user liked, so the saved cart feature may not accurately reflect what the user clicked on. This issue is partially alleviated if we limit how many products are shown to the user, making the gap between the reality and what we have on the hardcoded cart less than what it could be. We also overestimated what the user would save to be on the safe side.

# Limitations of the Prototype

- As we mentioned on the previous slide, our prototype does not support voice features for our conversation task. This may not satisfy the specific needs of the user if they want to use voice features.
- Similarly, typing input is also limited. The user cannot type whatever they want; instead, we will auto populate a response. This is unfortunate for users who want more control over what they want to search for on our app.
- Due to the static nature of the prototype, we cannot store memory of what specific products the user liked, so the saved cart feature may not accurately reflect what the user liked. This may cause dissonance for our users.
- We also used hard-coded data rather than Wizard-of-Oz features, which has its own limitations, as we explain on the next slide.

# Using Hard-Coded Data

When building our prototype, we chose to use hard-coded data rather than a Wizard of Oz type testing. This seemed more practical because it would allow people like our TA to test our prototypes when we are not present. Needing us to be present and fill in data in real time would severely limit the scope of our testing.

However, we do understand that this makes it quite difficult to fully use the conversational, mood querying part of Task 1 in a way that actually feels conversational. For the later tasks, it means that the app's state may not accurately reflect what actions the user performed. To make it a little more manageable, we chose to add messages to the particular responses that have not been implemented yet, and for the next prototype, we will hardcode multiple execution paths so it feels less restrictive.



# Appendix:

## Figma Prototype

Here is a link to the Figma prototype:

<https://www.figma.com/proto/HjiDS0MJZ6jzFV7R1OZQyu/GR6?node-id=0-1&t=iESr5twCCdTENqws-1>

You can access the README here:

<https://drive.google.com/file/d/1qwNaFidw3evgD9u9e3L4ZG7Mn9XB0RS8/view?usp=sharing>

